

Raspberry Pi-powered AI solution defeats US Air Force pilot in combat simulation

While the original aim of launching the Raspberry Pi was to just let enthusiasts test their DIY projects, now, leveraging some software tweaks, it can beat even



humans at their own game. Nick Ernest, a doctoral graduate from the University of Cincinnati, has designed an artificial intelligence (AI) solution for the single-board computer to prove its capabilities.

Called ALPHA, the

AI solution defeated retired US Air Force Colonel Gene Lee during combat simulation. Lee described the new development as “the most aggressive, responsive, dynamic and credible AI” solution, to date.

Flying against opponents on a flight simulator was not a new task for Lee as he has been beating computer programs since the early 1980s. However, ALPHA made the pilot “tired, drained and mentally exhausted” due to its exceptional results. “I was surprised at how aware and reactive it was. It seemed to be aware of my intentions and reacted instantly to my changes in flight and my missile deployment. It knew how to defeat the shot I was taking,” Lee said.

Ernest aims to enhance the AI program in the future by extending its capabilities and reducing mistakes. “The goal is to continue developing ALPHA, to push and extend its capabilities, and perform additional testing against other trained pilots. Fidelity also needs to be increased, which will come in the form of even more realistic aerodynamic and sensor models,” Ernest explained.

ALPHA could become the ultimate solution for air combat simulation. It could even emerge as a benchmark for other AI programs, and perform tasks based on the commands of a manned wingman in actual flight, using the power of Raspberry Pi.

NEC Corporation launches OSS Technology Centre in India

NEC Corporation and NEC Technologies India (NTI) have announced the



launch of their OSS Technology Centre in the country. The aim of the new organisation is to offer technical support related to the use of open source software.

Having begun operations on July 1, the new OSS Technology Centre will have around 50 people based in NTI. The staff

Microsoft brings Docker Datacenter to Azure Marketplace

At DockerCon 2016 in Seattle, Microsoft announced the debut of Docker Datacenter on the Azure Marketplace. The new move by the Redmond giant is apparently aimed at expanding its presence in the world of enterprises using open source technologies.

Mark Russinovich, Azure’s chief technology officer at Microsoft, showcased a Docker Datacenter-based container cluster that uses Azure resources and runs on a private cloud infrastructure managed by Azure Stack. “Deployment from the Azure Marketplace using pre-defined ARM (Azure Resource Manager) templates simplifies and reduces the time to start up Docker Datacenter and get productive,” Russinovich wrote in a blog post.



Microsoft tied up with Docker to bolster its development towards Linux solutions. The partnership has already resulted in the launch of some tools and extensions for Windows users. Most recently, Windows 10 got an update to let users natively use Docker on their systems.

In addition to the new Docker Datacenter announcement, Russinovich unveiled SQL Server in a Linux-based Docker container.

Microsoft’s SQL Server on Linux is presently available as a private preview. Users with preview access will now be able to get SQL Server on Linux directly on their Ubuntu systems — just as a Docker image.